Joel Leiva

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science: Cybersecurity, **Kean University, Union, NJ** *Appx. May 2027*

CERTIFICATIONS

Fortinet: FCF, FCA
Zscaler: Zero Trust Cyber Associate
CompTIA: Security +

WORK EXPERIENCE

Kean University, Information Technology – Union**,** NJ *June 2026 - Present*
Junior Security Operations (SecOps) Analyst

- Monitor enterprise security events in a **SIEM** platform, triaging alerts and investigating cases to identify threats, reduce false positives, and assess incident scope and severity.
- Collaborate daily with the Networking Team, Cloud Engineering Team, and Director of IT Security to investigate security events, support remediation efforts, and strengthen enterprise security operations.
- Develop automation scripts to streamline repetitive security workflows, reduce analyst workload, and improve operational efficiency.
- Designed and built an internal website (AI-assisted) to help new Security Operations analysts acclimate to the triaging process, understand investigation workflows, and become familiar with standard operating procedures.

House of Hearts, Department of Operations - NJ *August 2026 – Present*
Strategic Operations Manager

- Lead Information Technology and Access Advancement initiatives, strengthening the organization's technology capabilities and infrastructure to support staff, programs, and community services.
- Organize, maintain, and support the Foundation's digital infrastructure and develop technology solutions to improve operational reliability and efficiency.
- Collaborate with executive leadership to develop and implement strategic technology solutions, providing recommendations that promote innovation, strengthen operational capacity, and align technology resources with organizational objectives.

Kean University, Center for Cybersecurity – Union, NJ *September 2025 – May 2026*
Threat Intelligence and Analyst Intern

- Conduct open-source threat intelligence (**OSINT**) research focused on ransomware, data breaches, DDoS attacks, and emerging cyber threats impacting nonprofit and NGO organizations.
- Produce intelligence reports used to inform cybersecurity awareness and defensive decision-making for more than 60 nonprofit organizations.
- Designed and deployed a physical cybersecurity laboratory consisting of switching infrastructure, network storage, power distribution, and surveillance systems for hands-on security research.

PROJECTS/PROGRAMS

NCyTE Cybersecurity Career Challenge – *Online Student* *February - May*

- Managed a Proxmox-hosted, **multi-tier network** environment consisting of **10 endpoints** over VPN, facilitating routers, firewalls, web and mail servers, Active Directory/DNS, database server, and client endpoints.
- Configured firewall policy, NAT, static routing, aliases, and segmented traffic across LAN, WAN, and DMZ zones to enforce **least-privilege** network access and improve perimeter security.
- Developed and secured an internal mail server on RHEL using Postfix and Dovecot with SMTP submission, IMAPS, SASL authentication, TLS encryption, and firewall service hardening.